



What is the #1 way people find work? ...Networking!

As of 2016, LinkedIn is the largest online professional network with more than 433+ million members in over 200 countries. Unlike Facebook, LinkedIn is for professional use only. That's what makes it so powerful in getting notice for your job search.

CREATE AN ACCOUNT

Go to **LinkedIn** (www.linkedin.com)

- Sign up
- Activate account by clicking the link in the confirmation email sent to you

BUILD A PROFILE

- **Photo** – professional headshot in JPG, GIF or PNG photo
- **Headline** – state what you do or are interested in (avoid 'unemployed' or 'looking for work')
- **Summary** – market your skills, expertise, experience, interests and vision
- **Experience** – include volunteer, internships and jobs with descriptive bullets starting with action verbs
- **Education** – include education, honours, awards, activities, courses and projects
- **Recommendations** – get recommendations from coworkers, professors or supervisors
- **Skills & Expertise** – list your relevant skills and get endorsed by your connections
- **Websites** – add links to your organization's website, blog, and professional social media ex. Twitter
- **Public URL** – update URL to your name and add LinkedIn to your résumé and contact cards

MAKE CONNECTIONS

- Use '*See Who You Already Know on LinkedIn*' to search your Email Contacts
- Search, find and invite colleagues, friends, classmates and business associates to join your network
- Use Advanced Search to find individuals by business, school or location
- Invite everyone you meet to connect with you on LinkedIn

JOIN GROUPS

Search under 'Groups' for your field of interest (ex: I.T., Marketing, Accounting, Toronto, Colleges, etc.). Join up to 50 groups and make sure to try to keep up with them.

Join groups to:

- Connect with individuals, organizations, associations and share information
- Link to members in the group
- Participate in discussions and share ideas and questions
- Find hidden jobs posted to group – often posted as a '*Discussion*' or on the '*Jobs*' tab
- Ask for advice and referrals
- Become a thought leader and get noticed
- Find out about local meetings to network in person

FOLLOW COMPANIES

Companies have their own profiles on LinkedIn and you can follow up to 1,000 companies and get updates on key developments and jobs that they post.

To follow a company:

- a. Move your cursor over the 'interests' link at the top of the homepage and select 'companies'
- b. Search for a company
- c. Click 'follow' in the upper right corner of the company's home page

SEARCH JOBS

Click on the 'Jobs' tab at the top of the page to "Search for Jobs" by keyword, see 'Jobs You May Be Interested In' and to 'Discover Jobs In Your Network'.

ADD MULTIMEDIA (LINKS, VIDEO, DOCUMENTS & PRESENTATIONS)

On all your education and experience areas of your profile you are able to add proof of your work or related images, documents, videos and presentations. Simply click on the square with the plus sign beside edit and add whatever content you would like others to see.

PARTICIPATE

- Follow top Influencers to learn about life and work
- Use Status Updates to microblog – share links, work and ideas
- Continue to Build Connections – search and invite people
- Write a Recommendation for a colleague and ask for recommendations from previous colleagues
- Contribute to Group Discussions by replying to threads that interest you or start your own

TIPS

- ✓ Only invite people to join your network whom you have met
- ✓ As with all networking never ask for a job; always ask for advice
- ✓ Look at profiles of those who are working in your area of interest to get content and set up ideas
- ✓ Look at the groups they've joined and whether you qualify to join those groups
- ✓ Add your LinkedIn account to your resumes, contact cards and email signature

PRIVACY

Unlike Facebook, you want your profile to be viewable so that potential employers can find you. You can control how people view your profile in the '*Privacy & Settings*' tab by clicking on 'Manage'. Also under this section, you can change how others see you when you view your profile.

Casa Loma Career Services

Room C317
(416) 415-5000 ext: 4100
clcareercentre@georgebrown.ca

St. James Career Services

Room B-155
(416) 415-5000 ext: 3818
sjcareercentre@georgebrown.ca

Waterfront Career Services

Room 017
(416) 415-5000 ext: 5301
wfcareercentre@georgebrown.ca

[OptimalResume](http://georgebrown.optimalresume.com) – build cover letter, résumé or practice interview skills: georgebrown.optimalresume.com

[GBCareers](http://gbcareers.georgebrown.ca) – view job postings and events: gbcareers.georgebrown.ca

[Georgebrown.ca/careerservices](http://georgebrown.ca/careerservices)